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A Global Perspective on Responsible Democratic Citizenship

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THE CONTEXT

- Citizenship is related to the nation state and emerged from the struggles for civic rights in that framework
- But what about quasi-sovereign regional (e.g. EU) or global (e.g. the UN) institutions? Can there be citizenship concepts, attitudes and arrangements vis-à-vis those?
- Does the “Citizen of the World” catchphrase have any real meaning?

ASPECTS OF CITIZENSHIP

- Reverence of founding documents and narratives
- In-depth knowledge of democratic institutions and processes
- Respectful behaviour within the community; rights with responsibilities
- Empowerment and agency
- Judgement, opinions on the basis of facts, resistance to fake news
- Multiple identities, but some more important than others?

CITIZENSHIP AND THE EU

CITIZENSHIP AND THE UN

- Founding documents and narratives
- Democratic institutions and processes
- Behaviour within the community; rights with responsibilities
- Empowerment and agency
- Judgement
- Multiple identities

IN COMES CYBERSPACE

- Large numbers of young people spend large parts of their time / lives online
- What is the source of legitimacy and the “sovereignty” in cyberspace?
- “Digital citizenship” – which aspects of citizenship apply (see previous slide)?
- Is digital citizenship more global or more fragmented?
- Can digital and traditional citizenship complement each other?

PROVISIONAL CONCLUSIONS

- Overlapping identities and citizenships
- EU/European and UN/Global meta-citizenships
- Cyberspace increasingly the main “locus” of loyalty and action?
- “The Babel Syndrome” – falling apart as we globalize?
- Learning and teaching citizenship

Thank You!

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